📖 Saving the World

Prologue: The Door Before the Door

TL by The Louman

The Beginning

It began on a normal Monday afternoon.

Molly sat in her room in Beijing, fiddling with her Rubik's Cube. It wasn't solved yet — but she didn't mind. Some puzzles, like people, weren't meant to be solved in a straight line.

On her desk, her phone recorded her as she answered questions for her new teacher.

"My name is Molly. I'm ten. I like the Rubik's Cube... reading... mythology..."

She smiled between thoughts, trying not to overthink.

"...and if I had a superpower, I'd pick time travel. To help scientists. And to know the secrets we don't know yet."

The moment she said the word "secrets," something invisible shimmered behind her.

She didn't see it. But something did.

✨ The Teacher Who Wasn't Just a Teacher

The next day, she joined her first class.

Her teacher's name was **Louman**. His hair was long — brown streaked with silver — like time had been leaving its own bookmark in each strand.

He smiled like a normal person. But his eyes looked like they'd seen *other centuries*.

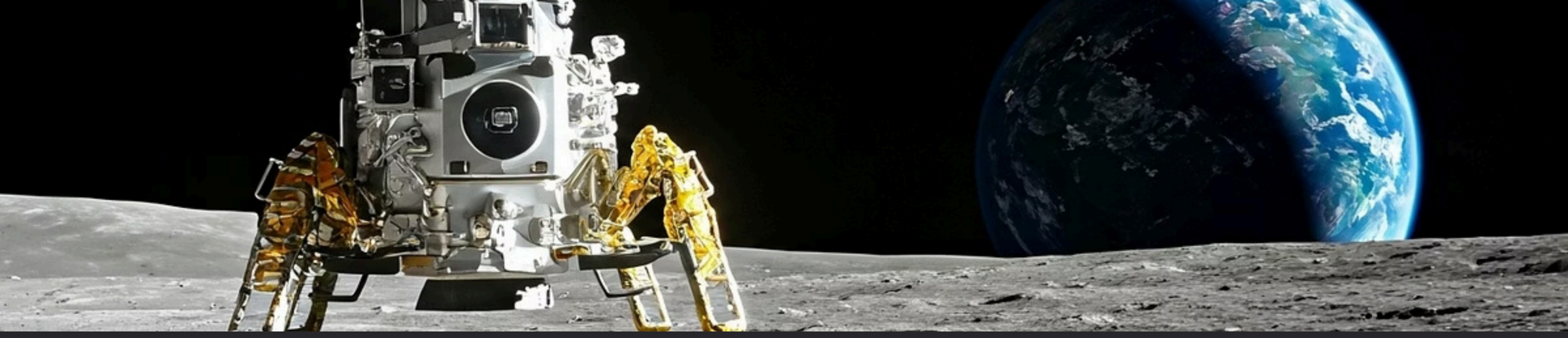
"Hi, Molly," he said. "Nice to meet you."

Before the lesson began, he leaned toward the camera. His face flickered slightly, as if the Wi-Fi couldn't quite hold him in this timeline.

"Molly," he said softly. "There is something waking up inside you. Do you feel it?"

Before she could answer, the screen glitched. For a moment, she saw something behind him — not a beach, but a vast library where scrolls floated and whispered in languages no one had invented yet.

Then… everything snapped back to normal.



🌕 The Class That Started the Story

They didn't talk about magic. They talked about the **Japanese Moon Mission** — and how a robot named *Tenacious* had landed in the Moon's Sea of Cold.

They studied words like:

- Telemetry
- Abort
- Module
- Impact
- Resilience

Louman said something she wouldn't forget:

> "Even if your landing is upside down, you still might send the most important message back to Earth."

And when Molly stepped into the simulation — reading her mission, choosing how to land — she didn't hesitate.

"I learned something," she said afterward. "That was success for me."

That was when Louman paused, watching her through the screen.

"Molly," he said, "you don't just *learn* stories. You live them."

And he smiled in that strange, quiet way he did.

Moon Mission Simulation

The simulation allowed Molly to experience what it would be like to control a lunar landing mission, making critical decisions that would determine success or failure.

Through this exercise, she discovered that learning itself was the true measure of success, not just completing the mission perfectly.

🌌 Night Falls, But Not Quietly

That night, she dreamed of heroes.

But not the *Percy Jackson* kind. Not the safe kind.

She stood on a cliff near a thunderous sea. The sky burned with orange clouds and purple lightning. And in front of her: twelve golden chairs, empty.

At the edge of the cliff was a table made of glass.

On it: a scroll.

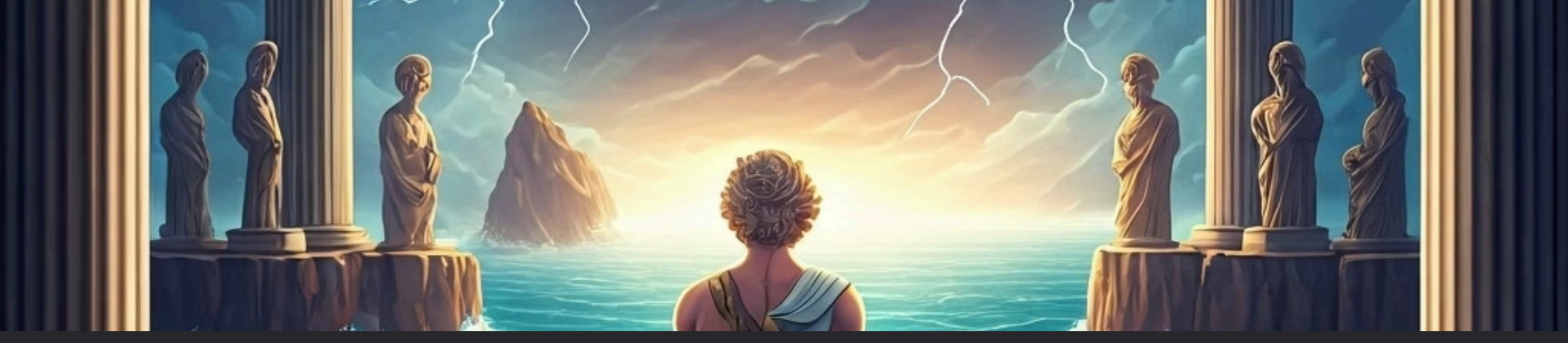
Written in strange Greek handwriting, with a message just for her:

> "You've been heard. You like questions we can't answer. So answer this: What if the myths were listening to *you*?"

A flash of lightning cracked the sky.

Suddenly, she was standing in a white marble hall filled with statues. Except... the statues were watching her.

And then came the thunder.



⚡ The God She Didn't Expect

From a beam of golden light stepped **Apollo**, radiant and glowing, wearing sunglasses far too modern for ancient Greece.

"I hear you don't like me," he said, brushing his perfect hair aside.

Molly blinked.

"I said your *poems* were weird. Not you."

Apollo smirked.

"Oh, you're funny. This will be interesting."

He tossed her a glowing medallion. It read:

SAVING THE WORLD*: MOLLY* Status: Activated

And behind him, ten golden doors appeared.

Each one flickered — **alive** with images from her mind:

- The Titanic, sunken but glowing
- A swarm of bees, frozen mid-flight
- The Mona Lisa, blinking slowly
- A Rubik's Cube, solving itself with invisible hands
- Sen Xingbui, wrapped in mist
- A volcano erupting in reverse
- A half-written story, its last sentence floating in midair
- Her best friend, waving from across timelines
- A mirror — showing her face, but older
- And one that simply read: To Be Chosen

🌀 The Return of the Long-Haired Stranger

Suddenly, behind her — footsteps.

She turned.

There he was again.

Not on a screen.

Standing beside her now — robe stitched with constellations, long silver hair glowing like strands of memory.

In his hand: a Rubik's Cube that kept shifting — even when solved.

The Beginning of the Journey

"I told you, Molly," he said, smiling. "There's something waking up inside you."

She blinked. "Who are you, *really*?"

He grinned.

"I'm Louman. Your teacher. Your guide. I'll show up in every chapter of this story — just not always the way you expect."

Molly looked at the cube in his hand.

"Even in the next chapter?"

He nodded.

"But you can only open the next chapter *after* your next lesson with me."

"Every class we have in the real world will give you a riddle."

"And every riddle you solve will unlock the next adventure."

He handed her a tiny scroll — no bigger than her finger.

On it was a single word, glowing faintly:

Greece

Then Louman stepped backward — into the flickering light of a myth just beginning to remember itself — and vanished.

And the doors began to rumble.

Behind her, Apollo clapped once, grinning like a boy about to lose a bet.

"You ready to pick your first door?"

Molly was. Almost.

And just before she reached out…

the thunder struck again.

This time, it whispered:

"Chapter One… is waiting."

Riddle Given	Doors Appear	Thunder Speaks
Louman provides the first clue	Ten magical pathways revealed	The adventure begins